

Alex Kulikov

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Latest public version at lxqu.dev/cv

Senior Backend & Platform Engineer
Ex-Meta • Production AI/Data Infrastructure • Reliability • Data Portability

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Ex-Meta Senior Backend / Platform Engineer with 9 years across large-scale infrastructure and early-stage AI/data companies. Owns production systems end-to-end: data pipelines, Terraform-managed AWS/GCP, reliability, and agent backends — from greenfield to audited, observable, cost-aware production. Led a 6-person workstream at Meta; maintainer of the open-source Data Transfer Project.

EXPERIENCE

onFabric | FOUNDING BACKEND ENGINEER

August 2025 – April 2026 | onfabric.io • context-use.com (open-source)

- Designed an ActivityStreams 2.0-extended schema unifying 6 provider parsers, then built an agentic codegen harness (schema contracts, generated conformance fixtures) that cut new-provider integration from 2–3 weeks to hours; 7 providers shipped, open-sourced as context-use.
- Owned Terraform-managed infrastructure across AWS, GCP, and Auth0: 400+ resources (ECS, RDS, SQS/DLQs, IAM/OIDC, Cloud Run, Vertex AI) across 7 stacks; 1TB assets, 300GB Postgres in production.
- Reworked all platform export ingestion into idempotent FastAPI and Rust pipelines: decoupled async GCS-backed staged processing and batching to isolate large-archive ingestion from the primary API; led the full backend migration to the new ETL pipeline with zero downtime.

Lerno | SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

May 2025 – December 2025 | Contract | lerno.ai

- Owned SOC 2 engineering readiness: migrated live AWS to Terraform (VPC, EC2/EBS, RDS, ElastiCache/Redis) and documented security controls for audit.
- Designed and shipped a streaming RAG agent for long-form meeting transcript Q&A (LangGraph): multi-source retrieval routing, prompt overrides, and SSE streaming.

Meta | SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

February 2020 – August 2024 | Promoted 2x, Senior since July 2022

- Led a 6-person reliability workstream on the [Data Transfer Project \(DTP\)](#), driving it to General Availability maturity (observability, integrity, SLOs).
- Reduced DTP failure rate from ~6% to <0.6% via infra hardening and transfer lifecycle UX features (proposed and shipped) to address unrecoverable error states.
- Identified and led a GDPR-compliant infrastructure refactor that became a DMA compliance prerequisite: shipped across two reorgs, negotiating eng allocation under deadline; owned DP eng delivery and served as DTP POC across DMA workstreams.
- Conducted 100+ technical interviews across hiring cycles.

Sysblok | HEAD OF ENGINEERING

Since November 2023 | Volunteer | sysblok.ru

- Own engineering strategy for a volunteer nonprofit science media platform with 170k subscribers, 80k MAU, 10+ services on 3 hosts, 200+ contributors.
- Lead a 5-engineer team: roadmap, hiring, cost optimisation, and infrastructure risk management (hosting/CDN migrations, self-hosted alternatives); grew one engineer into a team lead; integrated AI tools into editorial workflows.

Earlier:

- Yandex.Go** – Software Engineer (Jun 2018 – Jul 2019, C++/Python/MongoDB/ELK).
- Meta** – SWE Intern (Jul – Oct 2019) – shipped a [Mercurial snapshot extension](#)

CORE SKILLS

BACKEND / PLATFORM

Python • FastAPI • Node.js • TypeScript
• PostgreSQL • Redis • Celery •
APIs (REST/GraphQL)

AI / DATA

ETL • embeddings • semantic search •
retrieval • agent backends • LangGraph

CLOUD / INFRA

AWS • GCP • Terraform • ECS • RDS •
GCS • Vertex AI • Cloud Run • Docker •
CI/CD • IAM/OIDC

RELIABILITY

Observability • monitoring • Prometheus
• Grafana • idempotency • infra
reproducibility • cost-aware infra •
OpenTelemetry

LEADERSHIP

Technical leadership • mentoring • hiring
• roadmap ownership

EDUCATION

MOSCOW INSTITUTE OF PHYSICS & TECHNOLOGY

BSc APPLIED MATHEMATICS
& COMPUTER SCIENCE

Grad. July 2017 | Moscow, Russia

RECOGNITION

2023 Tech Nation, UK Global Talent Visa
2025 Maintainer, Data Transfer Project

LANGUAGES

Russian (native) • English (fluent)

TALKS

May 2026 [Claude Code Central London](#)
Mar 2026 [AI Tinkerers London](#)